



Future of AI agents

Think digital coworkers, not digital magic

Every technology has a phase where it stops feeling like a separate tool and starts becoming part of the environment. Search moved from a website to the address bar. Maps moved from desktop planning to phone navigation. Payments moved from banking portals to QR codes at tea stalls. AI agents are heading in the same direction.

Today, we still think of them as chat windows, browser helpers, coding assistants, customer support bots or workflow tools. Over the next few years, they will become a layer across operating systems, browsers, office suites, phones, enterprise software and smart devices.

That does not mean agents will become magical digital servants. It means more software will become action-oriented.

From assistants to digital coworkers

The language around AI is changing. Earlier, companies spoke about chatbots and copilots. Now they increasingly talk about agents, digital workers, workflows and orchestration. That change matters because the expectation is shifting from “answer this” to “handle this process.”

A digital coworker does not replace judgement. It handles repeatable effort. It can gather information, structure messy inputs, prepare drafts, monitor updates and flag decisions. For a student, that may mean tracking chapters, deadlines and weak topics. For a journalist, it may mean turning transcripts into quote banks and story angles. For a freelancer, it may mean preparing proposals and reminders. For an SME, it may mean classifying leads and drafting responses. For an enterprise, it